ROBERT PHILLIPS

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Education

Florida State University Tallahassee, FL
Bachelor's in Computer Science Expected Dec. 2026
Relevant Coursework: Practical Cyber Operations/CTF (CIS 4930) • Computer Security Fundamentals (CIS 4360) • Cybercrime Detection & Forensics (CIS 4385) • Network & System Administration (CNT 4603) • Operating Systems (COP 4610)

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, C, TypeScript, SQL, Bash
Security & Cloud: Splunk (SPL), Sysmon, AWS (EC2, VPC, IAM, CloudTrail), MITRE ATT&CK, Wireshark/tshark, pwntools, GDB, oletools
Systems & Frameworks: Linux, Nginx, Gunicorn, Flask, React, Express, PostgreSQL, Git
Certifications: CompTIA Security+ (in progress, expected Dec. 2026)

Technical Projects

AWS Cloud Detection Lab — *AWS (EC2, VPC, IAM, CloudTrail), Splunk, Sysmon*
- Built a cloud-hosted SOC lab in AWS with Windows and Linux endpoints forwarding Sysmon, Windows Security, and authentication logs to a Splunk SIEM, plus CloudTrail for AWS API activity.
- Simulated attacks mapped to MITRE ATT&CK (brute force, encoded PowerShell, scheduled-task and registry persistence) and wrote 7 custom Splunk detections with scheduled alerts and an ATT&CK coverage dashboard.
- Emulated a leaked-access-key attack against IAM, detected the enumeration and backdoor-user creation in CloudTrail, and published incident write-ups and detection queries on GitHub.

FSU CTF Challenges — *pwntools, GDB, Wireshark/tshark, oletools, Python | ctf.cs.fsu.edu*
- Solved ~50 challenges across binary exploitation, reverse engineering, cryptography, and forensics; wrote Python/pwntools exploits chaining stack-canary and format-string libc leaks into ROP chains, GOT overwrites, PIE bypasses, and shellcode injection on 32- and 64-bit ELF binaries.
- Analyzed a malicious macro-enabled Word document with olevba, deobfuscating a Base64/XOR VBA dropper and decrypting its AES-encrypted PowerShell stage; traced HTTP data exfiltration in a PCAP with tshark and performed disk-image and memory-dump forensics.
- Reversed binaries with anti-debugging checks (ptrace, timing, parent-process detection), decompiled Java and PyInstaller executables, and broke weak crypto via Håstad's RSA broadcast attack, MT19937 seed recovery, and ZIPCrypto dictionary cracking.

Cybersecurity Tools Web App — *Python, Flask, Gunicorn, Nginx*
- Built a Flask security toolkit with SHA-256/512, MD5, and SHA-1 hashing, Base64 utilities, and a permission-gated port scanner, deployed on Gunicorn + Nginx with an automated test suite.
- Developed a log parser that extracts IPs, HTTP status codes, failed login attempts, and suspicious activity from uploaded log files, directly mirroring SOC triage workflows.

Linux Kernel Elevator Module — *C, Linux Kernel API*
- Implemented a kernel-level disk I/O scheduling elevator module for the Linux kernel; compiled and ran successfully in a live kernel environment, demonstrating low-level systems programming in C.

Phi Gamma Delta Member Portal — *TypeScript, React, Express, PostgreSQL, Drizzle ORM*
- Built a full-stack portal used by 200+ members with server-side RBAC, scrypt-hashed Passport.js auth, and Stripe payments across 14 database tables.

Work Experience

System Rethink Fort Myers, FL
Medical Billing Assistant May 2022 – May 2025
- Maintained sensitive patient records in a HIPAA-compliant EHR system; enforced data privacy controls and access management over 3 years.
- Performed QA review against CPT/ICD coding standards to identify billing discrepancies within secure, access-controlled internal systems.

Extracurricular Activities

FSU Cybersecurity Club Tallahassee, FL
Active Member Aug. 2023 – Present
- Participate in CTF competitions and attend talks from experienced industry professionals through the FSU Cybersecurity Club.

Phi Gamma Delta Fraternity Tallahassee, FL
Men's Mental Health Chair Aug. 2024 – May 2025
- Led semester check-ins, weekly chapter wellness recognition, and a chapter-wide health competition for 210+ members; independently managed multiple personal member cases requiring discretion and follow-through.